

DoView Tool G3 - Strategic Research Planning

G3

Below are the steps that are undertaken when using a strategic research planning approach. In order to do these steps draw on relevant DoView Planning tools. As the use of AI increases, it should be able to assist in various ways with the tasks outlined below.

1. Pool research funds wherever possible; treat them as a single R&D resource that informs ongoing strategic decision-making for the research field.
2. Build a DoView strategy/outcomes diagram for the overall research domain.
3. Capture existing evidence and theoretical claims as “This-Then” links within the DoView diagram.
4. Engage researchers, funders, stakeholders, and decision-makers to define the strategic research questions that must be answered to advance the steps and outcomes in the DoView diagram.
5. Ideally set up a credible Strategic Research Oversight Group for the research domain to undertake steps 6 -12 below. This will be more feasible in narrow research domains which have only a few funders. It is not feasible in large fields where there are many funders and research groups. However, even in those fields an strategic evaluation oversight advisory group could be set up to undertake the steps 6 -12 below and just distribute it as suggestions to funders and research groups in the topic area.
6. Map research questions on the DoView diagram next to the boxes they relate to.
7. Prioritise which research question(s) are priorities for the next period.
8. Decide what study designs will best address the highest-priority research questions.
9. Do not pre-set how much funding a single study deserves; allocate resources in proportion to the study’s potential to answer strategic research questions.
10. Map current and planned studies onto the diagram, showing which questions each addresses.
11. Feed completed study findings back into the DoView diagram to update the ‘This-Then’ logic captured in the DoView.
12. Widely disseminate the updated DoView in the research, funder and stakeholder community and have it inform the next planning cycle in which research funding decisions will be made.